SAMUEL MEKONNEN ERKUYE

Sales Development Representative • Cold Calling & Outbound Prospecting • B2B SaaS Pipeline

Remote from Addis Ababa, Ethiopia • Available full U.S. business hours (ET–PT)
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Phone-first SDR with 2+ years of B2B outbound and business development experience: 150–250+ outbound dials and 80–150+ inbound calls a day with U.S. contacts on U.S. business hours. I set up a sales department from scratch as the first sales hire at 3BL Studios. I research accounts, cold call decision-makers, qualify real pain and book meetings. I've also built the proposals, business cases and pricing conversations that turn meetings into deals, so I know the quote → approval → proposal → contract process from the inside. A software background (JavaScript, Python, web development) means I pick up technical SaaS products fast and explain them plainly to CROs, RevOps and Finance leaders. I'm looking for a role as the first SDR helping a quote-to-contract SaaS company build a repeatable outbound motion.

CORE SKILLS

- **Outbound prospecting:** Cold calling (150–250+ dials/day), multi-touch call + email + LinkedIn sequences, social selling, personalized follow-up after live conversations
- **Qualification & meetings:** Discovery questions, BANT/MEDDIC-style qualification, objection handling, booking and handing off qualified discovery meetings to leadership
- **Commercial process:** Quotes, pricing and discount approvals, proposals and business cases, order forms, contract and e-signature steps, deal-stage progression
- **Sales tools:** CRM: HubSpot, Salesforce • Dialers: Five9, PhoneBurner, Freshsales Dialer, Zoiper 5, Kwality Tel • Prospecting: LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Upwork • Collaboration: Slack, Microsoft Teams, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace • AI: ChatGPT, Claude for account research and personalization
- **Technical:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, Dart/Flutter; IT support and networking; Canva and Adobe Suite

SALES EXPERIENCE

Business & Sales Development Representative | MMCY Tech (U.S.-headquartered BPO & software firm) **Apr 2024 – Present**
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia (onsite, U.S. hours) • Client programs: Verma Soft, Alliance • Promoted from SDR (Apr–Aug 2024)

- Run full-cycle B2B outbound for MMCY's software and outsourcing services: research target accounts, cold call and email decision-makers, qualify needs, and move opportunities from first touch to closed deal.
- Make 150–250+ outbound dials per day on Five9, PhoneBurner and Zoiper, booking an average of 8+ qualified meetings per month (consistently at or above target) and contributing $80K+ in qualified pipeline.
- Build tailored demos, proposals and business cases that tie scope and pricing to each prospect's goals; work with marketing and development teams to adjust offers and resolve objections before contract.
- Write personalized proposals and bids for B2B tech projects on Upwork and outbound channels, earning a ~15% reply/interview rate.
- Handled high-volume inbound and outbound calls to shareholders of U.S.-listed companies, explaining meeting agendas, voting procedures and deadlines under strict regulatory compliance, handling 80–150+ inbound calls per day.
- Log every call, email and stage change in the CRM so leadership has an accurate, forecastable pipeline.

Sales Development Representative (Part-time) | 3BL Studios **Jun 2026 – Oct 2026**
Remote • First sales hire: built the sales department from the ground up

- As the first sales hire, set up the whole sales function from zero: defined the ideal customer profile and buyer personas, built targeted lead lists, and wrote the call scripts, email sequences and objection-handling guide.
- Built the CRM pipeline, deal stages and weekly activity reporting (dials → conversations → meetings) so leadership could track and forecast outbound performance from day one.
- Ran daily outbound calling and email alongside my full-time role, booking an average of 5+ qualified meetings per month and handing them off to leadership with full call notes.

Assistant Business Developer | Ethiopian Finance and Asset Management Group (EAFMG) **Sep 2023 – Feb 2024**
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Ran market assessments, data collection and analysis to size opportunities and guide go-to-market decisions.
- Managed contractor relations, budgets and financial controls across several workstreams, which taught me how Finance teams review spend, pricing and approvals.

Article Writer & Marketing Specialist | Empire Syndicate (U.S.) **Oct 2023 – Jan 2024**
Remote

- Wrote and edited SEO-optimized B2B articles, newsletters and campaign copy for U.S. audiences. That experience shows in my cold emails and LinkedIn messages.

Co-founder | Tankua Special Events • Hammer Youth Educational Consultancy **Oct 2023 – Apr 2024**
Bahir Dar & Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Co-founded two early-stage ventures and sold their services directly to clients. Ran digital and community outreach campaigns, hosted events in two cities, and designed a 5-day study-abroad intensive course.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Admin & Marketing Assistant | African Career Networks, African Leadership Academy **May 2024 – May 2025**
Johannesburg, South Africa (remote)

- Planned content calendars and campaigns across newsletter, social and Mighty Networks; produced speaker series and fireside chats; screened candidates and tracked placements.

IB Computer Science TA & Tech Support | SOS Hermann Gmeiner International College **Aug 2022 – Jun 2023**
Accra, Ghana

- Taught programming, coached STEM competition teams, and resolved hardware, software and network issues in person, by phone and remotely. Good practice for making technical topics simple.

Leadership | African Leadership Academy & BUILD in a Box Ethiopia **2021 – 2023**

- CFO & AV Production Manager of a student enterprise (business plans, OKRs, revenue targets); Educator in the ALA Global Scholars Program; Camp Director for tech and entrepreneurship camps in three Ethiopian cities.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Advanced Diploma | African Leadership Academy **2022**
Johannesburg, South Africa

High School Diploma | Bahir Dar STEM Center **2020**
Bahir Dar, Ethiopia

Languages: English (C1, professional working proficiency) • Amharic (native)